Republic of the Philippines
Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
BANGSAMORO TRANSITION AUTHORITY PARLIAMENT
Bangsamoro Government Center, Cotabato City

THIRD REGULAR SESSION

PARLIAMENT RESOLUTION NO. 528

RESOLUTION CALLING ON THE PHILIPPINE NATIONAL POLICE AND OTHER RELEVANT LAW ENFORCEMENT AUTHORITIES TO IMMEDIATELY INVESTIGATE THE SHOOTING OF TWO YOUNG ADULTS, BOTH HUFFADH, IN SHARIFF AGUAK, MAGUINDANAO DEL SUR, AND TO TAKE DECISIVE ACTION TO ENSURE JUSTICE, COMMUNITY SAFETY, AND THE PREVENTION OF SIMILAR INCIDENTS

WHEREAS, the Bangsamoro Transition Authority (BTA) Parliament, as the legislative body of the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM), upholds the principles of justice, security, and peace as enshrined in the Organic Law for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao and the Constitution of the Philippines;

WHEREAS, it has come to the attention of this Parliament that two young adults, both *huffadh,* or memorizers of the Holy Qur'an, were tragically and senselessly shot in Shariff Aguak, Maguindanao del Sur on November 14, 2024, demanding immediate investigation and action;

WHEREAS, the killing of these individuals, who have devoted their lives to memorizing the Holy Qur'an is a reprehensible act that deeply wounds the moral and spiritual fabric of the Bangsamoro community, and such incidents threaten public safety, peace, and social harmony in the region;

WHEREAS, the BTA Parliament strongly condemns this senseless act of violence against the two young *huffadh* and calls for the immediate arrest and prosecution of those responsible;

WHEREAS, the Police Regional Office - Bangsamoro Autonomous Region (PRO-BAR) and other relevant law enforcement agencies are mandated to uphold public safety, investigate crimes with transparency and efficiency, and bring perpetrators to justice in order to protect the Bangsamoro people;

WHEREAS, it is imperative to take immediate action not only to resolve this case but also to prevent similar violent incidents that undermine public trust in law enforcement and disrupt the region's path toward peace and development:

NOW, THEREFORE, be it

RESOLVED, as it is hereby resolved by the Bangsamoro Transition Authority Parliament, To call on the Philippine National Police and other relevant law enforcement authorities to immediately investigate the shooting of two young adults, both *Huffadh*, in Shariff Aguak, Maguindanao del Sur, and to take decisive action to ensure justice, community safety, and the prevention of similar incidents.

RESOLVED, FURTHER, To urge the PRO-BAR and other pertinent law enforcement authorities to:

(1) Launch an urgent, thorough, and impartial investigation into the shooting of two young adults in Shariff Aguak, Maguindanao del Sur to determine the facts surrounding the incident, identify the perpetrators, and hold them accountable to the full extent of the law;

(2) Ensure the swift apprehension and prosecution of the suspects responsible for this heinous crime to serve as a deterrent to future acts of violence and reaffirm the region's commitment to justice and the rule of law;

(3) Deploy heightened security measures in Shariff Aguak and nearby areas, including increasing police visibility, enhancing patrols, and implementing community-based crime prevention programs to restore peace and order;

(4) Establish active coordination with local government units (LGUs), community elders, religious leaders, and other stakeholders to address the root causes of violence and strengthen peacebuilding initiatives in the affected areas;

(5) Provide necessary assistance and protection to the families of the victims, including psychological and social support, to help them cope with the aftermath of this tragedy;

(6) Undertake a comprehensive review of the security landscape in Shariff Aguak and other areas of Maguindanao del Sur to identify vulnerabilities, recommend reforms, and implement measures to mitigate the risk of violence; and

(7) Regularly update the Bangsamoro Parliament on the progress of the investigation and related law enforcement activities, and provide any policy recommendations to enhance the safety and security of the Bangsamoro people.

RESOLVED, FURTHERMORE, To furnish a copy of this resolution to the Police Regional Office - Bangsamoro Autonomous Region, the Ministry of Public Order and Safety, the Bangsamoro Human Rights Commission, the Office of the Chief Minister, and other relevant agencies for their immediate and appropriate action.

ADOPTED, *Sha'ban* 12, 1446/February 11, 2025.

Certified Correct:

PROF. RABY B. ANGKAL
Secretary-General

Attested:

ATTY. PANGALIAN M. BALINDONG
Speaker

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